

JOB INTERVIEW

ENGLISH FOR PROFESSIONALS

Level B2 · Forbes English

Illustration: professional in interview setting

LET'S TALK

Work in pairs or small groups. Look at the photos and discuss the questions below.

Interview preparation

Panel interview

Handshake / job offer

Have you ever had a job interview in English? How did it go?

What do you find most difficult about interviews — the questions, the nerves, or the language?

What do you think interviewers look for in a strong candidate?

VOCABULARY

Match the photos to the words. Then complete the missing letters beneath each picture.

cover letter

candidate

panel interview

competency

shortlist

strengths

body language

follow-up email

probation period

job offer

cover...

candidate...

panel...

competency...

shortlist...

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c _ _ _ _ _ cy

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strengths...

body...

follow-up...

probation...

job...

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pr _ _ _ _ _ n p _ _ _ _ d

j _ _ _ o _ _ _ _ r

LET'S PRACTISE

1. Underline the correct word to complete each sentence.

- We received over 200 applications and made a **shortlist / cover letter** of ten.
- Please attach your **competency / cover letter** when you apply online.
- Strong **body language / probation period** can make a great first impression.
- The successful **candidate / job offer** will start in September.
- After six months you complete your **shortlist / probation period**.
- She sent a professional **follow-up email / panel interview** the next day.
- They asked about my key **strengths / shortlist** and areas for development.
- A **panel interview / cover letter** involves more than one interviewer.
- He was delighted to accept the **job offer / competency**.
- Describe a time you showed the **competency / follow-up email** of leadership.

Candidate at a desk

Panel of interviewers

WO

1. cover letter
2. candidate
3. panel interview
4. competency
5. shortlist
6. strengths
7. body language
8. follow-up email
9. probation period
10. job offer

Handshake

Reading a job offer

Illustration: candidates waiting outside interview room

questions you might be asked in a job interview.

things you should do to prepare for an interview.

things you should NOT say to an interviewer.

qualities employers look for in a B2-level candidate.

ways to make a good first impression.

documents you typically bring to an interview.

follow-up actions after an interview.

WHAT DO THEY REALLY MEAN?

Match each interview question (1–8) with the skill the interviewer is really testing (a–h).

1) Tell me about yourself. ----

2) What is your greatest weakness? ----

3) Where do you see yourself in five years? ----

4) Can you describe a time you dealt with a difficult colleague? ----

5) Why do you want to work here? ----

6) What would your previous manager say about you? ----

7) How do you prioritise when you have multiple deadlines? ----

8) Do you have any questions for us? ----

a) Interpersonal and conflict-resolution skills

b) Motivation and knowledge of the company

c) Self-awareness and honesty

d) Time management and organisation

e) Ambition and career planning

f) Preparation and genuine interest

g) Self-presentation and communication

h) Awareness of how others perceive you

LET'S PLAY

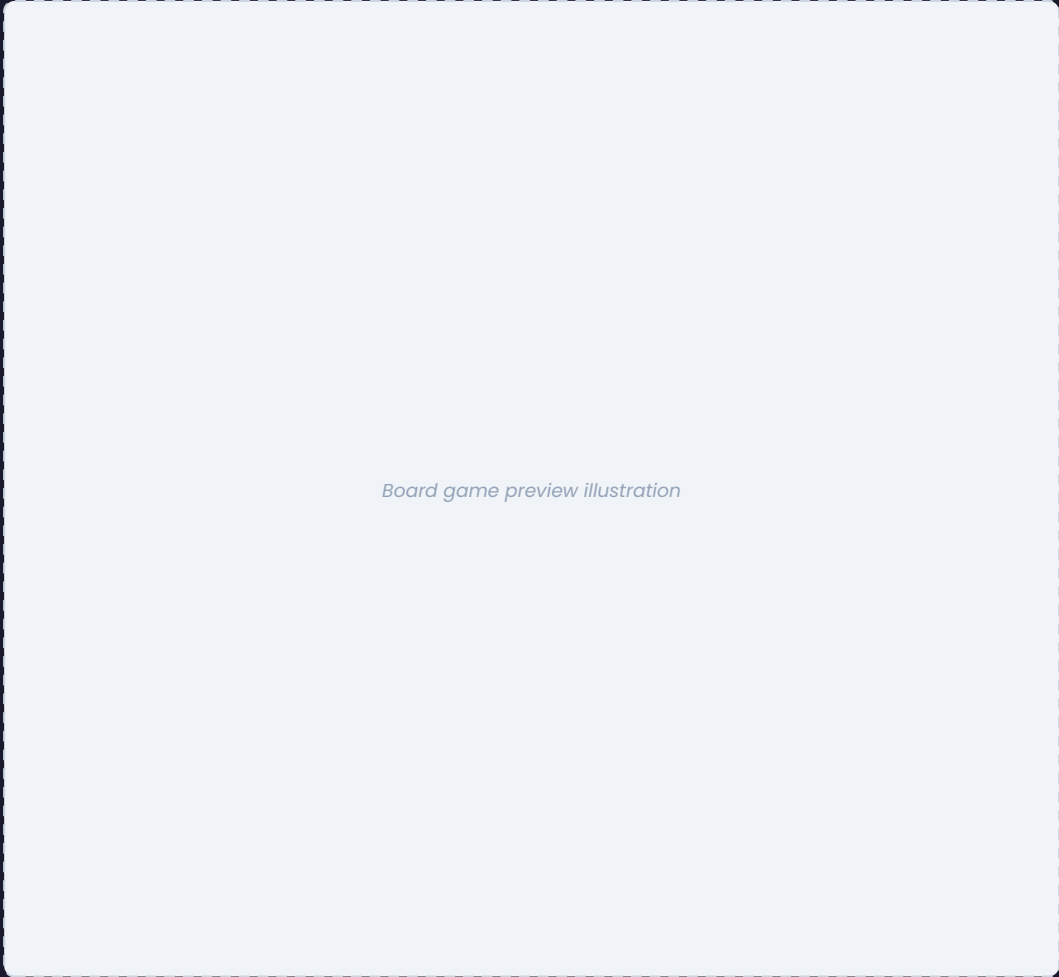
Play the board game. Practise your interview vocabulary and speaking skills.

Play in pairs or small groups.

Good luck — you've got the job!

PLAY NOW

Board game preview illustration



ALL ABOARD!

Illustration: two people having a formal conversation

1. Listen and number the events (1–6) in order.

- ☐ The interviewer asks about strengths and weaknesses.
- ☐ The candidate introduces themselves.
- ☐ The interviewer offers the candidate a glass of water.
- ☐ They discuss the candidate's experience.
- ☐ The candidate asks a question about the role.
- ☐ The interviewer explains the next steps.

2. Tick () the phrases you hear.

- ☐ I'm a real team player.
- ☐ My greatest weakness is probably perfectionism.
- ☐ I applied because I admire your company's values.
- ☐ I work well under pressure.
- ☐ I don't really have any questions.
- ☐ Could you tell me more about the team structure?
- ☐ I'd say my biggest strength is communication.
- ☐ I'm available to start immediately.

PREPARE YOUR ANSWERS

Study the interview question types below. Choose one question from each category and plan your answer.

Category	Example Question	Useful Language	Your Answer
Strengths & Weaknesses	What is your greatest strength?	I would say that... / One of my key strengths is...	Write your answer here...
Motivation	Why do you want this role?	I'm particularly drawn to... / I've long admired...	Write your answer here...
Competency	Describe a time you led a project.	Using the STAR method: Situation, Task, Action, Result	Write your answer here...
Future goals	Where do you see yourself in five years?	I hope to... / My long-term goal is to...	Write your answer here...
Questions for the interviewer	Do you have any questions for us?	Could you tell me more about... / What does success look like for this role?	Write your answer here...

Illustration: notepad and pen

ROLE PLAY

Work in pairs. Choose one situation. Read your role card and act out the conversation. Use polite, formal language.

Illustration: two people shaking hands

First Interview

Student A:

You are the candidate. Greet the interviewer, introduce yourself and answer questions about your experience.

Student B:

You are the interviewer. Welcome the candidate, ask about their experience and why they applied.

Useful phrases:

- Thank you for seeing me today.
- I have x years of experience in...
- I applied because...

Strengths & Weaknesses

Student A:

You are the candidate. Answer confidently. Use a real weakness but show what you are doing to improve.

Student B:

You are the interviewer. Ask follow-up questions. Push for specific examples.

Useful phrases:

- One of my key strengths is...
- I would say my weakness is...
- For example, last year I...

Competency Question

Student A:

You are the candidate. Use the STAR method to answer a question about teamwork.

Student B:

You are the interviewer. Listen carefully and ask: 'What was the result?' at the end.

Useful phrases:

- The situation was...
- My task was to...
- As a result, we managed to...

Questions for the Interviewer

Student A:

You are the candidate. Ask three thoughtful questions about the role and the company.

Student B:

You are the interviewer. Answer professionally and assess how well-prepared the candidate seems.

Useful phrases:

- Could you tell me more about...
- What does success look like in this role?
- What are the next steps?

EXTRA TASK

1. Watch the video and answer the questions.

Video thumbnail: mock job interview

- What position is the candidate applying for?
- What example does she give of a strength?
- How does she handle the weakness question?
- What question does she ask the interviewer?
- What advice does the interviewer give at the end?

2. Imagine you are preparing for this interview.

Write your answer to ONE of the interview questions from the video. Use at least 60 words and include a specific example.

EXTRA TASK

weak interview answer below. Rewrite it using all ten words from the box to make it stronger.

cover letter

candidate

panel interview

competency

shortlist

strengths

Weak answer:

"I'm good at my job. I worked at a company for three years. I did a lot of things. I want this job because it seems nice. I don't really have any questions."

Your improved version:

Illustration: person writing notes

EXTRA TASK

Look at the word cloud and practise making sentences using the vocabulary from the lesson.

Word cloud: briefcase silhouette shape using lesson vocabulary

REVISE

Revise your interview vocabulary before the next lesson.

Use the Quizlet set to review all ten key words and phrases.

You can play games, test yourself, or practise with a partner.

Illustration: person studying on laptop / flashcards

[Open Quizlet Set ›](#)

YOU'RE HIRED.

Well done on completing the lesson.
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Illustration: candidate celebrating / receiving job offer letter